



- 3 Lightning occurs when charge builds up in the atmosphere, creating a potential difference between the ground and the atmosphere.

During a lightning strike there is an average current of $3.3 \times 10^4 \text{ A}$ for a time of $2.6 \times 10^{-5} \text{ s}$.

- (a) Calculate the charge transferred during the lightning strike.

charge = C [2]

- (b) The potential difference between the ground and the atmosphere is $3.0 \times 10^7 \text{ V}$.

Calculate the average power, in GW, transferred during the lightning strike.

power = GW [2]

- (c) A lightning rod is attached to a tall building to conduct charge safely to the ground. The lightning rod is modelled as a uniform cylindrical copper cable of total length 95 m that runs from the ground to the top of the building, as shown in Fig. 3.1.

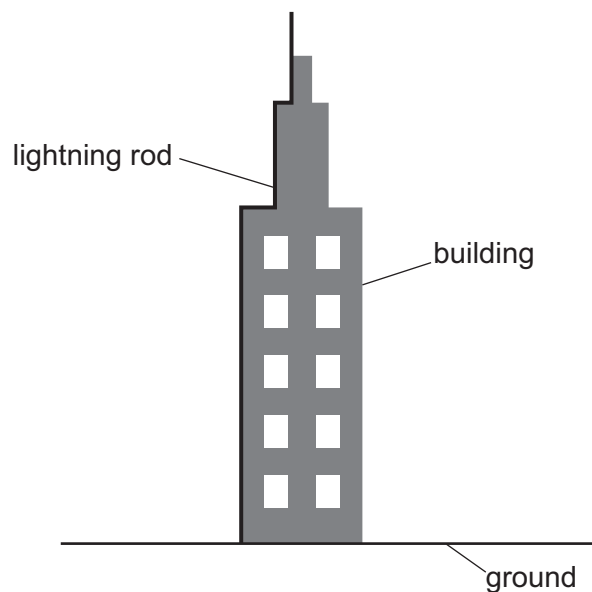


Fig. 3.1



- (i) The resistance of the lightning rod is $9.6\ \Omega$.
The resistivity of copper is $1.7 \times 10^{-8}\ \Omega\text{m}$.

Determine the radius of the lightning rod.

radius = m [3]

- (ii) The radius of the copper lightning rod is doubled with no change to its length.

State the effect of this change on the resistance of the lightning rod.

..... [1]

- (d) A section of the lightning rod of length 0.12m is removed for testing. A tensile stress of $1.9 \times 10^6\text{Pa}$ is applied, as shown in Fig. 3.2.

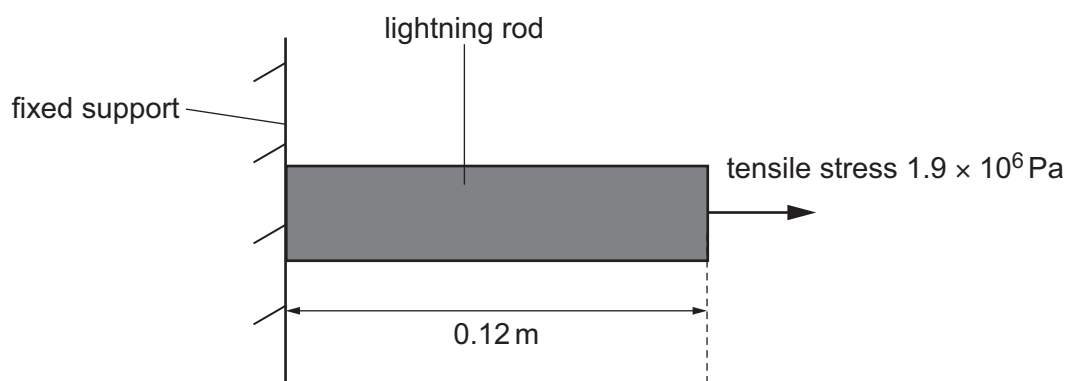


Fig. 3.2 (not to scale)

The section of the rod obeys Hooke's law. The Young modulus of copper is $1.3 \times 10^{11}\text{Pa}$.

Calculate the extension of the section.

extension = m [3]

[Total: 11]

